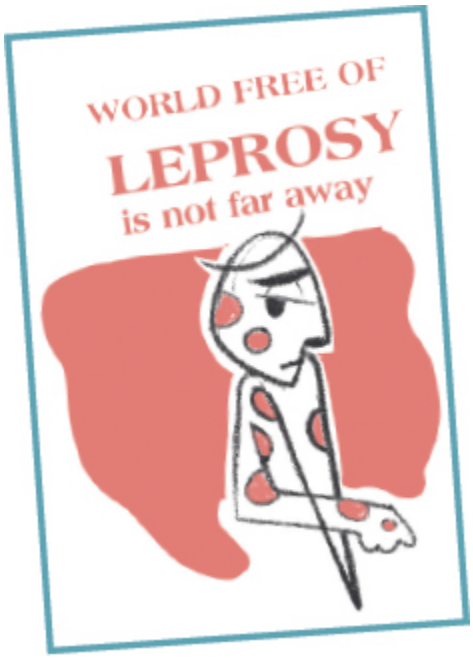
bring change by being part of local government. Inspired by Gandhi, he subsequently chose to renounce his wealth and live simply.



People with leprosy faced social stigma, and were often forced to live in isolation in poor conditions. Horrified by their plight, Amte was moved to study the disease, its symptoms and treatment protocols.

Love over fear

In the 1940s, Amte encountered a man suffering from the debilitating effects of leprosy, a disease that was thought to be highly contagious and was incurable at the time. In 1949, he set up the Maharogi Sewa Samiti (Leprosy Relief Society), and leased land from the government to set up a treatment and rehabilitation centre. This would come to be known as Anandwan, a village built and run by leprosy patients, where they engaged in agriculture and small-scale industrial production. Amte later set up several establishments and projects, including an orphanage, a home for the elderly, educational institutions and several communes and villages for the socially marginalized. In 1946, Amte fell in love with and married Sadhana (Indu) Guleshastri. The marriage was an unusual one at the time because it